



CATEGORY		GRAPHICS & PROFESSIONALS PRINTERS		
Brand		Canon	Epson	HP
Model		i905D	Stylus Photo 900	Photosmart 7960
FEATURES (20%)	Printing technology	Thermal Inkjet	Piezoelectric	Thermal Inkjet
	Resolution (dpi x dpi)	4800 x 1200	5760 x 720	4800 x 1200
	Interface	USB	Parallel / USB	2 x USB
	Input buffer	NA	32 KB	16 MB
	Paper capacity input tray	100	100	100
	LCD panel	✓	✗	✓
	Memory card reader	✓	✗	✓
	Camera port	✓	✗	✗
	Accessories	CD-face printing tray	CD-face printing tray	✗
	Standalone printing possible	✓	✗	✓
	Data cable included	USB	Parallel	USB
	Accuracy of ink tanks status through driver (S05)*	2.5	4	4
	Special features	Pictbridge	Paper-roll printing	✗
	Speed test (in seconds)			
	Text print - Normal	55	40	18
PERFORMANCE (70%) + COST PER PAGE (10%)	Text printout - Best	106	80	113
	Combi-document - Normal	90	48	46
	Combi-document - Best	122	94	127
	Photo printout	150	141	299
	Quality test (S05)*			
	Text quality (Best)	3	3	3.5
	Image quality (combi-document, Normal)	3.3	3.1	3.6
	Image quality (combi-document, Best)	3	3.5	3.7
	Image quality (photo, Best)	3.1	3.2	3.6
	Cost per page (Rs)			
OVERALL SCORE	Cost per black page	2.06	4.66	3.06
	Cost per colour page	4.04	2.94	2.43
	Cost of black cartridge	545	1520	978
	Cost of colour cartridge	2725	1840	1615
	Performance + Cost per page	59.43	60.99	63.25
	Features	11.8	8.6	10.6
	Grand Total	71.23	69.59	73.85
	VFM	3.24	4.80	4.34
	Price (Rs)	21,995	14,495	16,999
	Grade	B	B	B

* Scale of 5

Conclusion

For the home segment, our Best Performance vote goes to the Canon xnu i255 printer for its good performance, reasonable number of features and an equally good print quality. If you are looking for a printer that can print crisp text printouts and fairly good images, then opt for the Canon i255. The Best Value award goes to the HP Deskjet 3550 for its impressive performance and output quality at an excellent price of just Rs 3,000. The HP Deskjet 3550 stands out as a good printer for text printing as well as those occasional photo prints.

For the SoHo segment, our choice for the Best Performance crown was unanimous—the Canon i560. The i560 combines the best of everything to deliver groundbreaking speeds, without compromising on quality. The price is a bit high, but it is worth the money if you want a really fast inkjet printer for your small office. The HP Deskjet 5652, on the other hand, offers excellent output quality at reasonable speeds, earning itself the Best Value award. Buy the HP 5652 if your needs pertain to printing image documents, for which it's actually better than the Canon i560. 

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